



MONTHLY RUNNING COST — RESEARCHED ESTIMATE

What it costs to run the platform

A researched breakdown of monthly cloud costs in Australian dollars, built on exact AWS Sydney pricing. Shows the cost at each stage of growth — from the first charity to one hundred — and the recommended server size.

A\$450/mo

To launch & run with the first charity

~A\$34/tenant

Typical per-charity cost at 100 tenants

c7i.xlarge

Recommended server (4 vCPU / 8 GB)

The key idea: total cost rises with each charity — from about A\$450 to A\$3,380 a month over the first 100 tenants. Cost *per* charity falls and settles near A\$34 — though it varies with the size of the organisation and how heavily it uses the platform.

1 Cost at each stage of growth

The cost is a **fixed platform base** plus an amount that grows with each charity. The table shows real monthly figures in AUD at every growth band, using exact AWS Sydney prices.

FIXED BASE

The platform itself

- Cloud server(s) — AWS EC2 c7i
- Shared database — MongoDB Atlas
- Load balancer, backups, monitoring

GROWS WITH TENANTS

Capacity added as we scale

- File storage & data traffic per charity
- More servers for load & uptime
- Larger database tier as data grows

TENANTS	SERVERS	DATABASE	OTHER AWS	TOTAL / MONTH	COST PER TENANT
1	A\$260	A\$121	A\$69	A\$450	A\$450
2 – 5	A\$260	A\$121	A\$109	A\$490	A\$98
5 – 15	A\$520	A\$121	A\$274	A\$915	A\$61
15 – 50	A\$780	A\$300	A\$810	A\$1,890	A\$38
50 – 75	A\$1,040	A\$300	A\$1,200	A\$2,540	A\$34
75 – 100	A\$1,222	A\$782	A\$1,376	A\$3,380	A\$34

Monthly figures in AUD, at the upper end of each band. "Servers" = EC2 c7i.xlarge instances. "Database" = MongoDB Atlas. "Other AWS" = storage, data traffic, load balancer, monitoring, email, DNS.

WHAT CHANGES AT EACH BAND

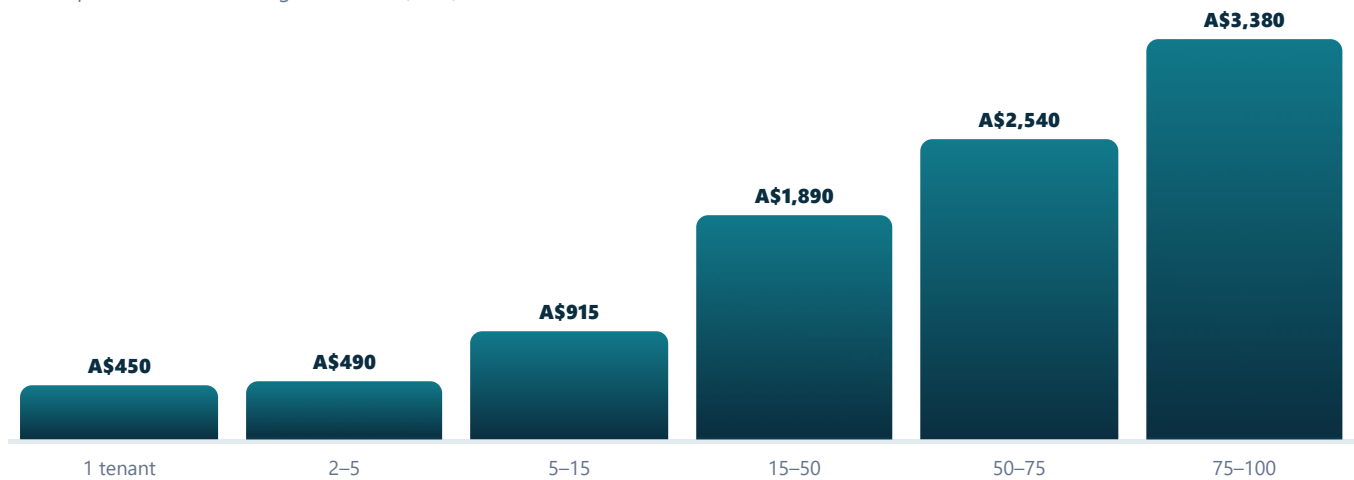
1	One c7i.xlarge server + entry database (Atlas M10). Full platform live.
2–5	Same single server — plenty of headroom, only storage/traffic grows.
5–15	A 2nd server is added for high availability — zero-downtime updates & failover.
15–50	Database upgraded (M10→M20); servers auto-scale to 3 as traffic rises.
50–75	A 4th server added; data traffic becomes a larger share of the bill.
75–100	5-server fleet + larger database (M30) for the heavier load.

Already covered — A\$0: the customer website runs on Vercel's free hosting and the domain is already purchased. Neither adds to this bill.

2 The two trends, visualised

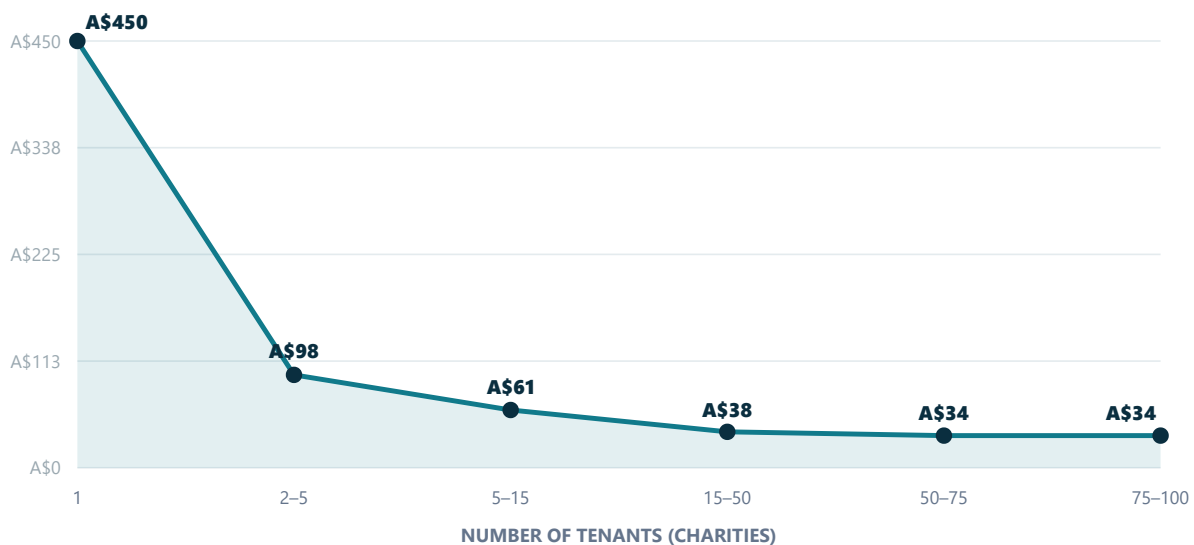
TOTAL MONTHLY COST — RISES WITH TENANTS

Whole-platform cost at each growth band (AUD).



COST PER TENANT — FALLS, THEN SETTLES NEAR A\$34

Monthly cost to serve *one* charity at each band. It drops, then levels off — it does not fall to near-zero.



THE PER-TENANT COST IS AN AVERAGE — IT VARIES

A\$34 is a *blended* figure. The real cost of a charity depends on:

Size of the organisation

More staff and board users means more accounts, documents and activity. A small charity (5–10 users) costs far less than a large one (100+ users).

Incoming traffic & activity

Frequent logins, report generation, file uploads and downloads all consume server time and data — a busy charity costs more than a quiet one.

In practice a light, small charity may cost around **A\$20/month**, while a large, highly active organisation can run **A\$70–90/month**. A\$34 is the typical blended average across a mixed customer base.

3 Recommended server size

The backend runs the API, live updates (websockets) and **PDF generation with a headless browser**. PDF generation is the heaviest task — each report briefly uses a full processor core and several hundred MB of memory. The server is sized around that.

AWS EC2 — c7i.xlarge

Compute-optimised · Asia Pacific (Sydney)

A\$260/mo

A\$0.357 / hr (US\$0.2331)

4

VCPU

8 GB

MEMORY

4–6

PDFS AT ONCE

~A\$187

/MO W. 1-YR PLAN

- ✓ 8 GB memory comfortably runs the API, live updates and several PDF jobs at the same time
- ✓ 4 processor cores absorb PDF bursts without slowing down normal requests
- ✓ Compute-optimised (c7i) — best value for this CPU-heavy workload
- ✓ A 1-year commitment cuts the price about 28% — from A\$260 to ~A\$187 / month

WHY NOT SMALLER OR LARGER

OPTION	SIZE	COST / MO	VERDICT
c7i.large	2 vCPU / 4 GB	A\$130	Too small — PDF jobs risk running out of memory
c7i.xlarge	4 vCPU / 8 GB	A\$260	Recommended — right fit for launch to 100+ tenants
c7i.2xlarge	8 vCPU / 16 GB	A\$521	Only needed beyond ~150–200 tenants

AUTO SCALING GROUP (ASG) SETUP

STAGE	MINIMUM	NORMAL	MAXIMUM	PURPOSE
1 – 10 tenants	1	1	2	Single server — lean launch
10 – 50 tenants	2	2–3	4	2+ servers across zones for zero-downtime
50 – 100 tenants	3	4–5	6	Adds capacity automatically at peak

Servers scale out automatically when processor use passes 60%, and scale back in when quiet — so we only pay for extra capacity during busy hours.

4 Breakdown & pricing sources

Where the **A\$3,380 / month** goes at 100 tenants — the largest band.



Cloud servers (EC2)		A\$1,222
Data traffic		A\$924
Database (Atlas)		A\$782
Monitoring, email, DNS		A\$230
Load balancer + storage		A\$222

Data traffic is a major share at scale — it grows directly with how much charities log in, generate reports and download files.

EXACT PRICES USED (AWS SYDNEY, 2026)

SERVICE	EXACT RATE (AUD · USD)	USED FOR
EC2 c7i.xlarge	A\$0.357/hr · US\$0.2331 → A\$260/mo	Main application server
EC2 c7i.large	A\$0.178/hr · US\$0.1166 → A\$130/mo	(Compared — too small)
MongoDB Atlas M10 / M20 / M30	~A\$121 / ~A\$300 / ~A\$782 per mo	Shared tenant database
Data transfer out	First 100 GB free, then A\$0.174/GB	Traffic to users
EBS gp3 disk	~A\$0.147 / GB-month	Server disks
Application Load Balancer	~A\$0.038/hr + usage	Traffic routing + HTTPS
S3 file storage	A\$0.038 / GB-month	Documents & uploads

AWS bills in USD. AUD figures use 1 USD = 1.53 AUD. Sources: [aws-pricing.com](#), [mongodb.com/pricing](#), AWS pricing pages.

TWO COSTS SHOWN SEPARATELY (NOT INFRASTRUCTURE)

Payment processing (Stripe)

~1.7% + A\$0.30 per charge. Charged only on income actually received — it scales with revenue, not servers.

AI assistant (OpenAI)

Pay-as-you-go, ~A\$30–45/mo at the start. Usage-based — only costs what charities actually use.

Estimate — not a quote. Built on exact AWS Asia Pacific (Sydney) list prices, May 2026, with on-demand servers and a shared MongoDB Atlas database. Per-tenant cost varies with organisation size and traffic. Excludes staff wages, marketing and office overheads. A 1-year server commitment lowers every figure by roughly 25–28%.